

Sarah Jade Pratt

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Dual American-Canadian citizen

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Computing Science · Simon Fraser University Sep. 2024 – Aug. 2026

Burnaby, Canada · Supervised by Dr. Lawrence Kim · HCI focus

- Relevant coursework: Machine Learning (A+), Natural Language Processing (A+), Advanced Human-Computer Interaction (A+)

Bachelor of Arts in Computer Science · University of British Columbia Sep. 2016 – May 2020

Vancouver, Canada · Minor in Applied Music Technology

- Dean's List all eligible years · Outstanding International Student Award (\$8,000)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant · Simon Fraser University, Tangent Lab Sep. 2024 – present

Supervised by Dr. Lawrence Kim · Tangible user interfaces, embodied interaction, directional audio systems

- Leading end-to-end development of a novel embodied directional-audio system, implementing full ROS/MoveIt/RViz pipelines for gestural beam-steering, motion planning, and interactive control; contributing toward an upcoming peer-reviewed submission.
- Designed, planned, and conducted multiple user studies — including gesture elicitation (n=15), need-finding, and semi-structured interviews — analyzing qualitative and quantitative data to ground engineering decisions in real user behavior.

Undergraduate Research Assistant · University of British Columbia, School of Music

Jan. 2017 – Dec. 2017

- Applied geocoding and temporal visualization methods to analyze the geographical evolution of polyrhythmic music traditions; analytic contributions acknowledged in a published paper at ICMPC/ESCOM 2018.
- Gained experience in computational analysis, interdisciplinary research, and linking quantitative methods with cultural and cognitive inquiry.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant · Social Issues & Communication Strategies in Computing Science · SFU

Jan. 2025 – present

- Mentored 200+ engineering/CS students in technical writing, ethical argumentation, and audience-focused communication through individualized written and verbal feedback.
- Evaluated 400+ written and oral assignments; supported rubric calibration and assessment standards across sections, developing expertise in scientific communication.

Head Teaching Assistant · Introduction to Computing Science and Programming · SFU

Sep. 2024 – Dec. 2024

185+ students

- Evaluated 700+ assignments and exams; built custom grading automation scripts that reduced turnaround time and improved feedback consistency.

- Supported instruction in foundational computing concepts and Python; provided in-lecture assistance, helped develop midterm/final exams, and led office hours for algorithmic reasoning and shell-based workflows.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Developer · RedMane Technology LLC Feb. 2021 – Jun. 2024

Production SaaS · Government & social-service case management · Burnaby, BC

- Owned delivery of large-scale case management features across multi-year government contracts, improving workflow efficiency and data integrity for thousands of end users.
- Collaborated closely with PMs, designers, and non-technical program leads to translate ambiguous stakeholder requirements into clean, maintainable implementations.
- Diagnosed and resolved a critical production outage under pressure, strengthening debugging and systems-thinking skills and improving on-call documentation to prevent recurrence.

Acoustic Software Developer Intern · BlackBerry QNX May 2019 – Dec. 2019

- Built interactive test frameworks for evaluating embedded voice-enhancement algorithms, integrating AWS Transcribe, Google Speech-to-Text, and CMU Sphinx for automated speech analysis.
- Created data-driven visualization tools to surface acoustic performance metrics, guiding engineering and product decisions.

Recording and Audio Technician Work Study · UBC School of Music

Sep. 2016 – Sep. 2019

- Provided reliable access to recordings of concerts, recitals, and events; designed recording configurations, managed equipment, and performed audio/video editing for clients.
- Strengthened technical skills in signal flow, audiovisual production, and systematic workflow management.

DEMOS & PRESENTATIONS

Evaluating Consistency and Variability in Student Writing Assessment by Humans and AI

Apr. 2026

Western Canadian Conference on Computing Education, Vancouver, BC — including reviewership service

MILA Hackathon Finalist — Safer AI for Youth Mental Health

Mar. 2026

National hackathon hosted by MILA in Montreal, QC, in collaboration with Bell Canada, Buzz HPC and Kids Help Phone · \$250 prize

SyncFeel: Wearable Multi-Modal Rhythm Stimulation for Attention Enhancement

Sep. 2025

Finalist demo, ACM UIST Student Innovation Contest (SIC), Busan, South Korea · DOI: [dl.acm.org/doi/10.1145/3746058.3758974](https://doi.org/10.1145/3746058.3758974)

ConvoBuddy: Facilitating Conversation Entry

Apr. 2025

2025 SFU CS Diversity Awards shortlisted presentation

AWARDS & RECOGNITIONS

Special Recognition Prize · MILA Hackathon (Safer AI for Youth Mental Health) Mar. 2026

\$250 cash prize · MILA – Quebec Artificial Intelligence Institute, in collaboration with Bell Canada, Buzz HPC and Kids Help Phone

Nominated Finalist · Graduate Student Leadership Award, SFU School of Computing Science
Mar. 2026

Professional Development Grant · SFU Graduate Student Society Jan. 2026
\$500 funding for Spring 2026

Graduate Fellowship · SFU School of Computing Science Sep. 2025
\$1,663 funding for Summer 2025

Go Global Award: Global Seminar Programs · University of British Columbia Nov. 2019
\$1,000 award for travel to University of the Philippines for the Interactive Performance Systems collaborative project

Dean's List · University of British Columbia Sep. 2016 – May 2020
Awarded each eligible year for achieving 85%+ average on at least 27 graded credits per Winter Session

Outstanding International Student Award · University of British Columbia Sep. 2016 – Apr. 2017
Merit-based entrance scholarship of \$8,000